Jobs Phase 2 — Research & Open Questions

Tracking document for all items that need research, answers, or decisions before Phase 2 build can begin.

Status Legend: ⬜ Open | 🟡 In Progress | ✅ Resolved

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1. Specifications / Filters

The team has confirmed that replacing the subcategory-driven specs model with semantic key/value filters is **out of scope** for Phase 2. The following questions remain about how Jobs specs work within the existing system.

#	Question	Status	Owner	Answer
1.1	What specifications/filters need to exist for Jobs on the SRP? (salary range, hourly rate, job type — are these implemented as standard subcategory specs using the existing system?)	✅	Chris	Jobs fields (employmentType, educationLevel, yearsOfExperience, payRangeType, payFrom/payTo, companyPerks) are top-level listing fields but will be **mapped into the existing subcategory specs system** via Category Manager so they flow through the existing AvailableFilters pipeline.
1.2	How do Jobs specs get surfaced on the SRP within the current Category Manager / specs system? Does a Jobs subcategory already exist, or does one need to be created?	✅	Chris	Jobs category and subcategories **need to be created** in Category Manager as part of Phase 2. A **feature flag** is required in GraphQL to filter Jobs category out of production unless the user's member ID is in the team allowlist.
1.3	What is the impact on `AvailableFilters` in the SRP GraphQL call? Do we just add Jobs-specific specs through the existing mechanism?	✅	Chris	Some fields move to specSubCat slots (flow through AvailableFilters automatically). Pay range fields stay top-level and need custom filter mapping. See field mapping table below.
1.4	Is the Figma SRP mockup still accurate given the specs descope, or does it need to be updated to reflect the existing specs approach?	✅	Design	**Needs update.** Figma was designed around the new semantic filters — needs revision to reflect the existing specs system.

Jobs Field Storage Decisions

Field	Storage	Notes
`jobsEmploymentType`	**specSubCat (string select)**	Full Time, Part Time, Contract, Temporary, Internship, Seasonal
`jobsEducationLevel`	**specSubCat (string select)**	None, High School, 2 Year Degree, 4 Year Degree, Advanced Degree
`jobsYearsOfExperience`	**specSubCat (string select)**	None, 1-2 Years, 3-4 Years, 5-7 Years, 8-10 Years, >10 Years

Field	Storage	Notes
`jobsCompanyPerks`	**specSubCat (multiple string slots)**	Each perk as a separate spec slot (boolean-like select). Work remote, Flexible schedule, etc.
`jobsPayRangeType`	**Top-level**	"hourly" or "salary". Controls interpretation of payFrom/payTo.
`jobsPayFrom` / `jobsPayTo`	**Top-level**	int (cents). Range filter — needs custom filter mapping in SRP.
`jobsApplicationUrl`	**Top-level**	External apply link. Not filterable — Detail Page only.
`jobApplicationDeadline`	**REMOVING — TODO verify**	Marked for removal. Verify with team that this field is not needed.
`marketType`	**Top-level (existing)**	Add "Job" as a new valid value to the existing shared field.

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2. SRP (Search Results Page)

#	Question	Status	Owner	Answer
2.1	What Mongo fields need to sync to Elasticsearch for Jobs? Audit current Jobs data vs. what's already in ES.	✅	Engineering	specSubCat fields (employmentType, educationLevel, yearsOfExperience, companyPerks) should sync automatically via existing pipeline. Top-level fields (`jobsPayRangeType`, `jobsPayFrom`, `jobsPayTo`, `jobsApplicationUrl`) **need new ES mappings added** and Mongo connector updates.
2.2	How does listing type filtering work in ES today? Confirm the index structure and whether a `listingType` field exists or needs to be added.	✅	Chris	Yes — ES has `marketType` field which maps to "listing type" in the UI. Adding "Job" as a new `marketType` value (decided in 1.1) enables same-index filtering. No structural changes needed.
2.3	SRP display rules — who defines the frontend behavior? What does "list format" vs "grid format" look like? Is this covered in Figma?	✅	Frontend	**Frontend only.** Backend returns listings; frontend decides grid vs list based on selected categories. No backend display hints needed.
2.4	Is moving SRP search logic from GraphQL to a dedicated service still in scope, or was that tied to the specs redesign?	✅	Engineering	**Already completed.** SRP search logic has been moved to a dedicated backend service.
2.5	Frontend resource allocation — who from frontend is assigned and what is their availability?	🟡	PM	**Not yet assigned.** This is a blocker/risk — frontend work is required for SRP, Detail Page, and MyAccount.

#	Question	Status	Owner	Answer
2.6	How should Jobs appear as a listing type option alongside For Sale, In Search Of, and For Rent?	✅	Chris	**Top-level filter option.** Jobs appears as a selectable `marketType` filter alongside For Sale, In Search Of, For Rent. Users can toggle it on/off independently of category.

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3. Detail Page

#	Question	Status	Owner	Answer
3.1	What does the Phase 1 Listing Service already provide for detail page reads vs. what's missing for Jobs?	✅	Engineering	Listing Service GET endpoint exists but **needs expansion** to return Jobs-specific fields (pay range, employment type, application URL, etc.). GraphQL + frontend wiring also needed.
3.2	What Jobs-specific fields need to appear on the detail page? (Reference: Jobs Listing Fields research doc)	✅	Chris	**Standard:** Title, Description, Company Name (businessName), Photos, Location, Contact Info. **Jobs-specific from specSubCat:** Employment Type, Education Level, Years of Experience, Company Perks. **Jobs-specific top-level:** Pay Range (type + from/to), Application URL.
3.3	What is the GraphQL endpoint structure for updating a listing? Does this build on existing Phase 1 work or require new mutations?	✅	Chris	**N/A for Detail Page.** Listings are not edited from the Detail Page — editing happens via the Post-A-Listing (PAL) form, which is **out of scope** for this project. Detail Page is read-only.
3.4	Legacy compatibility — the doc mentions continuing to store contact info and verification status on listing documents near-term. What is the timeline/criteria for removing this?	✅	Chris	**Not applicable** to Phase 2.
3.5	Are Detail Page mockups/designs needed, or does the unified detail page handle Jobs dynamically?	🟡	Design	**Partially dynamic.** Design input needed for Jobs top-level fields only: pay range display, Apply button (applicationUrl). specSubCat fields render through existing specs UI.

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4. MyAccount

#	Question	Status	Owner	Answer
4.1	What existing ES queries are being reused for viewing listings in MyAccount? Identify them.	🟡	Engineering	**Needs investigation.** Engineering needs to audit current MyAccount ES queries to understand what exists and what needs updating for Jobs listings.
4.2	Soft Delete data model — what does it look like? (`deletedAt` timestamp? `status` field? Both?)	✅	Chris	**Both.** Use a status change (e.g., 'deleted') on the existing status field AND a `deletedAt` timestamp for auditing and purge scheduling.
4.3	Soft Delete retention period — what is the retention period before final purge? **Requires Legal input.**	🟡	Legal	**Not started.** Legal has not been contacted yet. This needs to happen before build to define retention period and purge behavior.
4.4	CX Restore tool — what is the endpoint contract? Has CX been consulted on their workflow needs?	🟡	CX	**Not started.** CX needs to be consulted to understand their restore workflow requirements before building the endpoint.
4.5	Does soft delete affect listing counts, search results, or billing?	✅	Chris	**Yes — full removal.** Soft-deleted listings are excluded from search (ES), don't count toward active listings, and billing/subscriptions stop. **Users can reactivate** within their limits, but must go through checkout flow again to pay for any canceled subscriptions. CX can also restore.
4.6	Edit flow — what fields can a user edit on a Jobs listing from MyAccount? Same as PAL or a subset?	✅	Chris	**No field editing in MyAccount** — editing goes through PAL (out of scope). MyAccount actions: **view, mark as sold, mark as sale pending, delete (soft delete), renew, reactivate.** Reactivate uses existing request activation endpoint. The rest (mark sold, mark sale pending, delete, renew) **need new endpoints on the Listing Service.**

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5. Saved Search Impact

The shaping doc warns: *"Take into consideration what effect this work will have on Saved Search."* There are 12,000+ saved searches that could be affected.

#	Question	Status	Owner	Answer
5.1	How are saved searches stored today? Do they reference specs IDs, category IDs, or URL patterns?	✅	Chris	**Deferred to Phase 3.** Saved Search & Alerts will be handled in the next build cycle.
5.2	Will any Phase 2 changes (new listing type, ES index changes) break existing saved searches?	✅	Chris	**Low risk / not a concern for Phase 2.** No existing saved search should match documents with Job data. Risk exists around saving new searches from SRP, but that's Phase 3 scope.
5.3	Is this a blocking concern for Phase 2, or documentation/prep for Phase 3?	✅	Chris	**Not blocking.** Phase 3 will handle saved search integration with Jobs.
5.4	Review the existing Saved Search & Alerts research doc for relevant findings.	✅	Chris	**Deferred to Phase 3.**

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6. App Work (2-week estimate)

#	Question	Status	Owner	Answer
6.1	When users select Jobs on app, what does "opens to pre-selected Jobs subcategories" mean? Which subcategories?	✅	Chris	**App-only feature.** When a user taps the Jobs tab, the app auto-selects the Jobs category and displays its subcategory list (same pattern as Services today). Jobs should also be removed from global search.
6.2	Does the unified detail page in app already support dynamic fields, or does it need modification for Jobs?	✅	App	**Needs modifications.** The app detail page needs changes to render Jobs-specific top-level fields (pay range, Apply button/applicationUrl).
6.3	PAL job-specific fields — what are they specifically? Who owns this list? (Reference: "hard-code fields similar to Cars")	🟡	App	**Needs clarification.** Confirm with App team whether PAL (posting/editing Jobs on app with hard-coded fields) is included in the 2-week app estimate or out of scope.
6.4	Does the app team have capacity within the timeline?	🟡	App	**Not confirmed.** App team needs to confirm 2-week availability for Phase 2 work.

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7. Cross-Cutting / Coordination

#	Question	Status	Owner	Answer
7.1	**Legal:** Has the conversation about soft-delete retention/purge behavior been initiated?	🟡	Legal	**Not started.** See 4.3. Needs to be initiated before build.

#	Question	Status	Owner	Answer
7.2	**Frontend:** Who is assigned? What's their availability window?	🟡	PM	**Not assigned.** See 2.5. Blocker/risk for Phase 2.
7.3	**Design:** Figma SRP mockups need updates. Are Detail Page and MyAccount mockups also needed?	🟡	Design	SRP Figma **needs update** (see 1.4). Detail page needs design for top-level Jobs fields only (see 3.5). MyAccount TBD.
7.4	**CX:** Restore tool endpoint — has CX been consulted on their workflow?	🟡	CX	**Not started.** See 4.4.
7.5	**Analytics:** What events/metrics should be instrumented? Is there a measurement plan?	🟡	Analytics	**Not started.** Needs discussion with analytics team.
7.6	**Trust & Safety:** Any considerations for Jobs listings (spam, scam patterns)?	✅	T&S	**Already handled** in Phase 1 / prior work. No additional T&S work needed for Phase 2.

Research References

Existing research docs from Phase 1 (in `Shaping Projects/Jobs to Classifieds/Engineer Research/`):

- Category Sub-cat Specifications
- Job Feeds
- Jobs Favorites
- Jobs Listing Fields For Moving Into General Classifieds
- Listing API requirements for Classifieds (draft)
- Listing Stats
- Pay ranges
- Quick Apply (Phase 4 — out of scope)
- Saved Search & Alerts (Phase 3 — but impacts need to be understood)
- Top Jobs